

LOCAL

Flock Safety removes license plate reader cameras in Springfield

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[Flock Safety](#) began removing its automated license plate reader cameras from Springfield's streets on Jan. 21.

According to the Springfield Police Department, all cameras are expected to be taken down by the end of the week.

Flock Safety [installed 25 ALPR cameras](#) around Springfield in September. The \$77,000 per year cost was funded by a grant. Springfield police turned them off after installation and they have remained off, with the exception of [an unauthorized activation](#) on Nov. 7.

In December, both the Eugene and Springfield police departments announced they were ending their contracts with Flock Safety after months of protest from community members and speculation as to whether Flock Safety and outside entities could be trusted with the data captured by the ALPR cameras.

"This move does not represent a shift away from ALPR technology itself," Springfield Deputy Chief George Crolly wrote in a press release, highlighting that SPD will continue working with local law enforcement partners to identify tools that police can use to enhance public safety and meet standards for data security, system transparency and operational control.

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